

BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter **The Daily Ceilidh**
in association with

FIRE ALARMS

The law on fire alarms in all Scottish homes is changing from February 2022.

It is the property owner's responsibility to ensure that their home / property meets the new standard, and it is important to note that home insurance policies may be invalid if the property doesn't meet the new legal standard.

By February 2022 every home must have:

- **Interlinked fire alarms. This means that if one goes off, they all go off.**
- **One smoke alarm in the living room or the room you use the most**
- **One smoke alarm in every hallway or landing**
- **One heat alarm in the kitchen**

If you have a carbon-fuelled appliance in any room, for example a boiler or fire, you must also have a carbon monoxide detector in that room, but this does not need to be linked to the fire alarms.

All smoke and heat alarms should be mounted on the ceiling, and must be interlinked.

You can use either sealed battery alarms or mains wired alarms. Both are interlinked by radio frequency, and so you do not need Wifi. If you use battery alarms, they must be sealed tamper-proof units and have long-life lithium batteries. You may be able to fit these alarms yourself. Mains-wired alarms are cheaper, but if you use them they must be fitted by a qualified electrician and must be replaced every 10 years, which may add to the cost. If you also need a carbon monoxide alarm and it is battery-operated, it must have a sealed battery for the duration of its lifespan.

You can buy both types of alarms online or in store from a number of retailers. However, you must check that each alarm complies with the following standards:

Smoke alarms
Heat alarms
Carbon monoxide detector

BS EN14604:2005
BS 5446-2:2003
British Kitemark EN 50291-1

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Contact us at: 01851 600 159
Text/Whatsapp: 07958 549784
Email: hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk
Or visit us online at:
www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk

Welcome to Issue 19 of the

Bernera News. Autumn is here and the moor colours are changing, bringing rain and beautiful rainbows which are apt, given the mixture of news.

It has been a sad time in the community, with the recent passing of Joan Macaulay of Kirkibost and Flora Mackay of Linshader. We offer our condolences to the families.

It has also been a time for celebration, with the first post lockdown wedding in the community hall, which has given much joy too. October is traditionally a time for celebrating harvest and for some, guising and halloween are highlights. Here at the **BN** we are celebrating the lovely entries in our sunflower competition.

FIRE ALARMS

Please note that the Nest Protect System will not meet the standard.

Older and disabled homeowners on low incomes can get help with costs. Contact Tighean Innse Gall for more information. 13 - 15 Francis Street, Stornoway. **01851 706121**.

If you are a private tenant, your landlord is responsible. If you are a council or housing association tenant, work is ongoing to make sure your home meets the new standards.

BREAST CANCER AWARENESS MONTH

1 in 7 women in the UK develop breast cancer during their lifetime. It is more common in older women. Men can also develop breast cancer, but numbers are a lot lower. Breast cancer is the most common cancer in the UK, with 15% of all newly diagnosed cancers in the UK being breast cancer. Around 55,200 people are diagnosed with breast cancer every year in the UK. That is around 150 people a day.

It is important to check your breasts on a regular basis.

Symptoms to look out for include:

A new lump or thickening in your breast or armpit

A change in size, shape or feel of your breast

Skin changes in the breast such as puckering, dimpling, a rash or redness of the skin

Fluid leaking from the nipple in a woman who isn't pregnant or breastfeeding

Changes in the position of the nipple.

These symptoms listed here are more often caused by other medical conditions. But if you have any of them it is important to see your doctor and get them checked.

COVID VACCINATION STATUS

With the introduction of the Covid vaccine passport scheme across Scotland and much of the UK, you may be required to provide evidence that you are fully vaccinated or exempt in order to attend certain events, or enter some venues.

If you are resident in Scotland you can get a vaccine status certificate by:

Using the NHS Scotland Covid Status App, which is free to download. This will allow access to a digital copy of your vaccine record on your mobile device. You will need a passport or driver's licence to complete the identity check.

Requesting a paper copy of your vaccine certificate from NHS Inform. You should also do this if you do not have a passport or driver's licence. Go to

<https://www.nhsinform.scot/covid-19-vaccine/after-your-vaccine/get-a-record-of-your-coronavirus-covid-19-vaccination-status> or phone **0808 196 8565**.

There are a very small number of people in Scotland who cannot be vaccinated for medical reasons. Those who have been identified as such will receive a secure paper exemption certificate in the post.

POWER OF ATTORNEY

Often seen as something for older people or those who have a known illness, most of us don't consider the need for a power of attorney. However, when the worst happens and we are incapacitated for some reason, whether by injury or ill health, sudden or over time, many of us will find that our trusted partner, family or friends have no legal right to make decisions about our health and care. The only way to ensure that this is not the case is by making a Power of Attorney and registering it with the Office of the Public Guardian (Scotland) ahead of time.

Judith Proctor, chair of the chief officer's group, Health and Social Care Scotland says: "Power of Attorney does not mean giving away your power or legal right, nor does it replace your will. It's more akin to the insurance policies we may have for our homes and our cars. With a Power of Attorney in place, a trusted family member or friend can carry out your instructions should you lose the ability to make your own decisions."

This may only be for a short period of time, for example if you are in hospital and needing someone to pay your bills for you, or for a longer term, for example if you are diagnosed with dementia and are unable to make important decisions for yourself.

A solicitor can help you put a Power of Attorney in place. To find a solicitor who is registered with the Law Society of Scotland, visit <https://www.lawscot.org.uk/find-a-solicitor/> or telephone them on **0131 226 7411**

Alternatively, if you are an older person, Solicitors for Older People Scotland (SOPS) is a group of solicitors dedicated to providing legal services to older and vulnerable people in a caring way, in partnership with Age Scotland. Find out more at <http://www.sops.org.uk> or by calling **0800 152 2037**

If you, or a loved one, has been diagnosed with dementia, Alzheimer Scotland offer information and advice at every stage of the dementia journey. Visit <https://www.alzscot.org> for more information or ring their 24 hour dementia helpline on **0808 808 3000**

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE QUIZ

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Hobbit hero of 'Lord of the Rings' | 18. Loyal dog at an Edinburgh kirk |
| 2. The acronym W.H.O. stands for | 19. Archipelago location of Global Seed Bank |
| 3. Britain's longest Motorway | 20. Nelson Mandela's home township |
| 4. What cheese does Wallace and Gromit eat | 21. Band that sailed in a Yellow Submarine |
| 5. Scottish royal house that ruled England also | 22. Mythical(?) continent in middle of The Pond |
| 6. Captain of the Starship Enterprise D | 23. Tchaikovsky wrote an overture for this year |
| 7. George Washington cut down what type of tree | 24. Who wrote 'I wandered lonely as a cloud' |
| 8. The World Economic Forum is held in this town | 25. House and garden that inspired 'Peter Pan' |
| 9. Jean Armour was the wife of which famous Scot | 26. And where is it located in Scotland |
| 10. The Wailing Wall is revered in which religion | 27. Silicate products made on this Venetian island |
| 11. Dominant male mountain gorilla is called a | 28. Locomotive holding world steam speed record |
| 12. Evening flight of flocking Starlings | 29. Oldest independent department store in Scotland |
| 13. Creature who gives money when dentist extracts | 30. Scotland v England rugby union famous trophy |
| 14. What type of bovine produces a cheese spread | |
| 15. The 'Three Field System' is an example of what | |
| 16. Founder of the Kirk | |
| 17. Largest body in the Solar System | |

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



MOTOR NEURONE DISEASE (MND) FUNDRAISER NIGHT



The BCA would like to thank everyone who donated and supported their fundraiser for MND Scotland which made it such a great success.

It truly was a wonderful night and between the funds raised on the night, the raffle, donations to the 'Just Giving' page, and other donations, the BCA have raised a final total of £7139.50. £1451 of this was donated by Peat and Diesel from their fundraiser in Stornoway.

They would also like to thank all of the volunteers who worked so hard to help the night run so successfully. Big thanks to you all.

POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS - SEAWEED HARVESTING

One of the activities we've been engaging in this year is gathering seaweed and experimenting with using it in all manner of ways. We admit we're only now starting to truly appreciate the wonder of this saltwater algae.

Did you know that there are around 10,000 species of seaweed in the world, and over 600 different varieties around the British Isles alone? They are classified into three groups – red, green and brown – with the green varieties favouring the shore and the brown types, such as kelp, growing in submerged forests beyond the low tide.

Seaweed is a superfood. What has long been a staple component of the East Asian diet (the Japanese consume 1.6kg of dried seaweed per person per year) is now experiencing a revival in the West. And seaweed not only provides nutrition for humans, it also serves as animal fodder and plant fertiliser, as well as being a crucial ingredient in pharmaceutical and beauty products.



Depending on the individual species, seaweeds are rich in calcium, phosphorous, iodine, magnesium, iron, potassium, sodium, copper and zinc, all of which are essential minerals for healthy bodies. They also contain Vitamin B12, the important element which tends to be lacking in vegan diets, as well as being a valuable source of fibre and protein.

So far, we've added seaweed to a carrot cake, to our nettle soup recipe and to our all-seasons quiche. We've also made Cornish pasties and seaweed bhajis, as well as substituting sea spaghetti for the more usual pasta in a tasty Italian dish. And one of our favourite snacks is kelp crisps.

Further culinary experiments will involve adding seaweed to bread and scones, patés and spreads, curries, burgers, salads and even drinks. And as the nights get shorter and cooler, we're looking forward to taking long seaweed soaks in our bathtub, to keep our skin moisturised and nourished during the winter months.



If you are fortunate enough to live near a place where you can forage your own seaweed, you may wish to try some of the recipes on The Cornish Seaweed Company website. Alternatively, their Seaweed Cookbook is well worth the investment.

Helen Strong
Kirkibost



BÀTAICHEAN



'S dòcha nach eil e cho glic a sgrìobhadh mu bàtaichean. Gun teagamh sam bith tha fada barrachd eòlais aig a h-uile duine a leughas seo air a' chuspair na tha agamsa. Nuair a bha mi nam leanabh bha sinn a' fuireach ann an taig an cois na mara. Ged a bha mi glè bheag fhathast, chòrd a' mhuir agus am fuaim nan tonn rium. Ach chuir sin dragh air mo mhàthair oir bha feugal oirre gun snàiginn sìos chun a' chladaich agus gum bhithinn air mo bhàthadh.

Co - dhiu rinn sinn imrich nuair a bha mi bliadhna a dh' aois agus chan fhaca mi a' mhuir a-rithist gus an robh mi anns a' bhun-sgoil.

Gach bliadhna rinn sinn cuairt gu àiteachan eadar-dhìleallaichte faisg air a' mhuir. Tha cuimhne agam air aon turas. Dh' iarr an tidsear iasad de bataichean iomraidh. Bha e mìorbhaileach gun d' fhuair a' clann gu lèir an cothrom a dhol gu muir airson greis.

Às dèidh an tachartas sin, chaith mi fhìn is mo charaidean tòrr ùine a' deanamh bàtaichean beaga agus bha sinn trang gan seòladh anns an t-sruth is anns an lòn.

Tron bhliadhnaichean a leanas thachair mi ri mòran shoithichean de gach cruth agus gach meud. Bliadhna neo dhà air a' bha taisbeanadh ann mu na Lochlannaich aig an taigh-tasgaidh ann am Peairt agus am measg nan nithean bha mac-samhail de longan aca, còig troighean deug a dh'fhaid.

Ach b' e bàta a chunnaic mi ann am Pearù a b' inntinniche. 'S e "Caballito de Totorà" a chanas iad ris (each beag de totora).

Tha na h-iasgairean air a bhith gan cleachdadh airson còrr is trì mìle bliadhna, agus that iad deànta cho chuilcean sonraichte: totora.

Nuair a tha iasgair a' dol gu muir, bìdh e na suidhe neo air a ghlùnean neo na seasamh anns a' bhàta agus tha aon ràmh aige. Tha na bàtaichean timcheall air dusan troigh a dh' fhaid agus dhà neo trì troighean a leud.

Bidh iasgairean ionadail gan cleachdadh fhathast ach an latha an-diugh tha iad femail airson gèamannan cuideachd, mar surfadh.

'S e pairt de' n dualchas culturach nàiseanta a th' anna a-nis.

Linne Macleod
Dun Innes



BERNERA BAKES... SPAGHETTI WITH SMOKED SALMON

INGREDIENTS:

450g spaghetti
2 tbsp olive oil
90g feta cheese
salt
fresh coriander

SAUCE:

300ml double cream
150ml whisky or brandy
125g smoked salmon
pinch of cayenne pepper
black pepper
2 tbsp fresh coriander

METHOD:

1. Bring a large pan of lightly salted water to the boil. Cook the spaghetti & 1 tbsp of olive oil until al dente. Drain the spaghetti, return to the pan, sprinkle over remaining olive oil. Cover, set aside & keep warm.

2. Pour cream into a small saucepan & bring to simmering point but do not let it boil. Pour whisky into another small saucepan and bring to simmering point but not allowed to boil. Remove both pans from heat and mix together the cream and whisky.

3. Cut the smoked salmon into thin strips & add cream mixture. Season to taste with cayenne & black pepper. Just before serving, stir in chopped fresh coriander.

4. Transfer spaghetti to a warm serving dish, pour over the sauce & toss thoroughly with two large forks. Scatter over the crumbled feta cheese, garnish with coriander & serve immediately.



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost



SUNFLOWER COMPETITION

With such a dry summer, the competition for the tallest sunflower has been fierce. The triumphant winner, with 5cm clear of the next tallest entry is Catherine Macaulay, 6 Kirkibost, at 2.3m. We only had room to fit our top 4 entries, (Runners up-Phoebe Sudderick, John Milns and Miranda Macdonald) but thanks to everyone who took part and sent their photos in. The prize of Garden centre vouchers and cheese board will be winging their way to Mrs Macaulay soon.



COMMUNITY NOTICEBOARD

JOB OPPORTUNITY ADMINISTRATOR ROLE BERNERA

Berner Community Association

1-year fixed term, full time
37.5hrs/week

Salary £19 - 23.4k
dependent on qualifications
and experience

Closing date for
applications:
5/11/21 at 6pm



Berner Community Association have been successful in securing a Covid regeneration grant and as a result are looking to recruit an administrator to maintain, manage and develop the community centre for activities promoted by the Bernera Community Association.

This is an exciting opportunity for the right individual to work at the heart of the Bernera community. Download the job pack and apply at www.bit.ly/JobBCA2021. If you have any questions, please email berneraca@gmail.com

GREAT BERNERA DEVELOPMENT TRUST



**WE NEED
YOU!**

The Great Bernera Development Trust have launched a questionnaire to enable Bernera and Tir Mor residents to have a say on what the Derelict Scottish Salmon Hatchery Building might be repurposed as. Working with the Bernera News, we are seeking your thoughts and ideas.



The hatchery is being purchased by the GBDT on behalf of the community, subject to successful funding which is helped by your ideas.

The consultation closes on the 31st October and can be found online at <https://bit.ly/GBDTConsult> or in the Bernera Cafe on the days it is open.

If you have any queries or need help with the form - You can contact Julia Higginbottom via whatsapp **07894516609** and she will help direct your enquiry.